

Research Conducted

What is cybersecurity?

Cybersecurity is the practice of protecting systems, networks, and programs from digital attacks, commonly called cyberattacks or hacking.

Think of cybersecurity as the digital versions of superheroes who stop the villains who try to rob banks. But in this case, the villains are doing it through the internet, and no one is held at gunpoint.

These cyberattacks are usually aimed at accessing, modifying, or destroying restricted sensitive information; extorting money from users through ransomware; or interrupting normal business processes.

Now we can try to prevent cyberattacks by implementing effective cybersecurity techniques. Effective techniques can work the best when they prevent damage to critical before they are even attacked, thus keeping all systems running at 100%.

Why is cybersecurity important?

As mentioned above, there are people who try different tactics in order to access restricted information, information they are not allowed to have. Without proper precautions taken, these people would have access to this sensitive information which would be illegal.

Safe browsing techniques

When you use a computer or the internet, you may think you are just accessing the information you want, but in the background, a lot could be happening.

Your activity could be monitored, you could be observed by malicious software made to steal your passwords,

you could even be tricked into clicking on unsafe links that give attackers access to all your sensitive information.

And the worst part is that you wouldn't even know until it's too late.

So here are a few things you can do to prevent this from happening

Be cautious with links and attachments

A new and arising dangerous attack used today is link redirection.

You click on a link that is intended to take you to your planned website, but it redirects you to a fake similar webpage.

More often, users cannot tell the difference, so they enter their personal information.

Verify the link before you click on it and check if it says that it will take you to where you want it to.

You could also use an online link verifier to ensure that it is safe to click.

Remember the phrase: think before you click

Use strong unique passwords

As the everyday systems we use develop, we are encouraged to come up with strong passwords that would be difficult to guess or predict.

Even so, you could still be at risk.

As unique as your password may be, you shouldn't reuse the same one across sites.

If one were to get their hands on it, they would have access to all the other sites with all your personal information.

Limit the amount of personal information you share online

As you explore various platforms, you will find yourself encouraged to share personal details to further improve your user experience. Many don't realize how much information is being collected over time.

Most already try their best to protect their data but regardless, companies still try to obtain some level of data from users.

Recognize emotional manipulation online

A lot of online threats, commonly scams rely on the psychological sense of urgency, fear, or excitement to persuade users to perform quick reactions to satisfy those emotions. Examples of this could be a bank telling you that your account was potentially hacked and requires immediate attention.

It is best advised to take a moment to think before you click or respond in order to break that psychological pattern. Slowing down is one of the most effective defences against manipulation-driven attacks.

Treat online safety as an ongoing habit

You need to understand that cybersecurity is a process, a habit and not a single one-time setup that works forever. As technology evolves, so do security threats and precautions that worked perfectly a year ago may not be sufficient in today's time.

Try to stay informed about potential dangers, continue to perform basic practices, and apply pattern recognition as you use these daily systems. You would be surprised how many users have been a victim and how it's not all just theory and risk.

What is phishing

Phishing is a dangerous tactic used by attackers to trick users to granting unauthorized access to sensitive information.

They do this by posing as a legitimate and professional organization. The messages are personalized and get increasingly difficult to distinguish from the legit organization.

Today, users have become more prone to phishing attacks as generative AI is able to make super realistic website/applications that look just as good as the original.

Unfortunately, this issue is bound to get worse as AI continuously evolves.

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